Till Arne Meissner

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Research Interests

Economic Geography | Global Value Chains & Foreign Direct Investment | Development Economics | Spatial & Applied Econometrics

Employment

London School of Economics and Political Science (LSE), UK Sep 2025 – present
Research Fellow, Department of Geography and Environment

- Spatial econometrics and causal inference (IGC-funded): satellite-based change detection and nighttime-lights analysis mapping illegal artisanal mining activity in Ghana; spatial clustering assessed via Moran's I and LISA statistics; causal effects on local economic and environmental outcomes estimated using event-study designs.
- Survey–geospatial data linkage for territorial analysis (STEG-funded): built and processed large satellite and climate datasets in Google Earth Engine, linked to household-survey microdata for Upper Egypt to study smallholder adaptation to climate change.
- Novel dataset construction (IGC-funded): built a firm-level dataset of green inward FDI for International Growth Centre partner countries using the EU Taxonomy of Sustainable Activities and LLM-based classification at scale; case studies in Ghana, Ethiopia, and Rwanda.
- Communicated findings to partner-country governments and development-finance stakeholders, translating technical and spatial analysis into policy-relevant evidence.

Education

London School of Economics and Political Science (LSE), UK 2020 – 2025
PhD in Economic Geography

- Dissertation: *"Essays on Global Value Chains and Economic Development"*
- Supervised by Professor Riccardo Crescenzi and Professor Andrés Rodríguez-Pose
- Funded by an ESRC Doctoral Training Partnership (DTP) scholarship; viva passed, degree conferred September 2025
- Examined the local and territorial economic effects of global value chain participation in low- and middle-income countries, integrating firm-level, household, geospatial, and satellite data; applied quasi-experimental and spatial-econometric methods (difference-in-differences, panel fixed effects, matching, spatial regression) to estimate causal impacts and spatial heterogeneity across three empirical papers (see Working Papers).

London School of Economics and Political Science (LSE), UK 2018 – 2019
MSc in Local Economic Development (Distinction)

- Winner of the MSc Local Economic Development Best Overall Performance Prize

University of Bayreuth, Germany 2012 – 2017
BA in Philosophy & Economics

- Erasmus exchange semester at Université Paris 1 Panthéon-Sorbonne (France)
- Global exchange semester at Kangwon National University (Republic of Korea)

Working Papers

Making Gains from Global Links: GVCs and Firm Upgrading in Africa. [Revise and Resubmit, Journal of African Economies]

Presented at the LSE Geography & Environment Work in Progress Seminar Series (2025).

Enclaves or Engines? SEZs and Local Economic Development in Ethiopia.
Presented at the LSE Geography & Environment Work in Progress Seminar Series (2025) and at SITES X Annual Conference in Development Economics, Rome (2025); chaired session on "Trade, Value Chains and Global Integration."

FDI, Employment, and Gender Equality: Evidence from Ethiopia.
Presented at the LSE Geography & Environment Work in Progress Seminar Series (2023); invited presentation at the STEG Annual Conference, Abu Dhabi (2024).

Work in Progress

- Green Foreign Direct Investment in Africa (with Juan Alvarez-Vilanova, Riccardo Crescenzi, Oliver Harman, James Hayward, and Christian Lippitsch). Featured in a co-authored IGC blog.
- Golden Traps? Self-Reinforcing Dynamics of Artisanal Mining (with Sreevidya Ayyar, Hemawathy Balarama, and Yoshiki Wiskamp).

Teaching Experience

ESADE Business School, Barcelona, Spain Sep 2026 – present
Teaching Assistant – Business in Society (MSc in Finance)

- Leading seminar discussions and grading case-study assignments on CSR, sustainability, and the financial sector's role in financing sustainable investments and social enterprises.

London School of Economics and Political Science (LSE), UK Sep 2021 – Jun 2025
Graduate Teaching Assistant

- Contemporary Europe (GY103): economics and politics of European integration and EU regional policy. LSE Class Teacher Awards 2022, 2024, and 2025.
- Introduction to Geographical Research (GY140): core statistical concepts, research methodology, and statistical software (R & Stata).

Conferences and Invited Presentations

2025: SITES X Annual Conference in Development Economics (Rome – session chair), LSE Geography & Environment Work in Progress Seminar Series

2024: STEG Annual Conference* (Abu Dhabi)

2023: LSE Geography & Environment Work in Progress Seminar Series

** invited presentation*

Other Experience

Scio Network GmbH & Co KG, Frankfurt, Germany Nov 2020 – Dec 2022
Senior Associate – Research Analyst & Business Operations

- Led conception, research, and drafting of a feasibility study on rigorous impact-evaluation designs for the GIZ Programme "Migration and Diaspora," synthesising academic and grey literature and assessing data requirements and cost implications.
- Conducted data analysis and project management for the GIZ Results Measurement Project, supporting results-based monitoring across development programmes.

GFA Consulting Group GmbH, Hamburg, Germany Sep 2019 – Sep 2020
Consultant – Private Sector Development

- Coordinated implementation of the EUR 6.1 million EU-funded "Assistance to the SADC Trade Related Facility," supporting the Southern African Development Community in harmonising technical standards and reducing non-tariff barriers.

- Led acquisition of the EUR 519,512 GIZ-funded project “Special Initiative Jobs – Upgrading the Textile and Garment Supply Chain” in Ethiopia, preparing the full technical and financial proposal.

GIZ GmbH, Eschborn, Germany Oct 2017 – May 2019

Intern & Consultant – Economic Policy and Enterprise Development

- Supported project coordination and advisory services for the Deutsche Gesellschaft für Internationale Zusammenarbeit (GIZ)'s Section for Economic Policy and Enterprise Development, including the design and early implementation of WIDU, a digital platform leveraging diaspora remittances for business financing in Cameroon and Ghana.

African Center for Economic Transformation (ACET), Accra, Ghana Sep 2016 – Dec 2016

Intern – Research Analyst & Policy Advisory

- Applied ACET's African Transformation Index methodology to assess economic transformation across 30 African economies for the African Transformation Report 2017.

Technical Skills, Languages, Service

Statistical Software	R, Stata, Python
GIS & Earth Observation	QGIS, ArcGIS, Google Earth Engine
Methods	Causal inference (DiD, event studies, panel fixed effects, matching); spatial econometrics (geographically weighted regression, Moran's I / LISA)
Languages	German (native), English (bilingual, TOEFL 114/120), French (fluent, C1), Spanish (upper intermediate, B2)
Service	Graduate dissertation support, LSE Geography & Environment Work in Progress Seminar Series co-organiser

Awards and Scholarships

Weltwärts Civil Service Grant, Ghana	2011 – 2012
Korean Government Scholarship (NIIED), Republic of Korea	2014 – 2015
Erasmus Scholarship, Université Paris 1 Panthéon-Sorbonne	2015
MSc Local Economic Development Best Overall Performance Prize, LSE	2019
ESRC Doctoral Training Partnership Scholarship (full stipend)	2020 – 2025
LSE Class Teacher Awards	2022, 2024 & 2025

References

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